As was to be expected, the tension in Jerusalem leads to scuffles. Hundreds of Palestinian youngsters entered Al-Aqsa Mosque late last night and started “fortifying” the sanctuary. After fruitless negotiations, the police entered the mosque and arrested some 350 youngsters. Most of them were released during the following hours. In the morning, calm had returned and prayers could be resumed. In the meantime, as a reaction, rockets were launched from Gaza on the surrounding settlements. The air force attacked twice. Gaza and Jerusalem are now relatively quiet. All in all, nothing dramatic yet.

The war between Ben-Gvir and Shabtai intensifies. Yesterday the minister apparently leaked a very problematic remark by the police commander, that it was in the Arab mentality to massacre each other. If this spreads—and according to the police, the quote is absolutely out of context—such a remark can do a lot of harm. The leak probably came in response to Shabtai’s previous speech, stating that the national guard would stay under police control. It seems that in Ben-Gvir’s entourage, people have recorded the conversations between the two, and other leaks can be expected.

I was asked to write something about Ben-Gvir’s private army. I won’t, not because the militia isn’t dangerous; it is extremely dangerous. But I find it hard to believe that Ben-Gvir will be able to set it up. The man is a clown, good at issuing threatening declarations in all directions. He managed to threaten Netanyahu about wrecking the coalition, but such a step is hardly believable. Where would the man find such a chance to threaten once more? He managed to antagonize the police to a point that has turned them into his enemies. Where will he find the volunteers for his force, if not among policemen?

The scuffles in Al-Aqsa started again. The police again used force to evacuate the mosque. Two rockets fired from Gaza during Seder evening. In Um el-Fahem, an Arab town in Israel, hundreds gathered in a solidarity